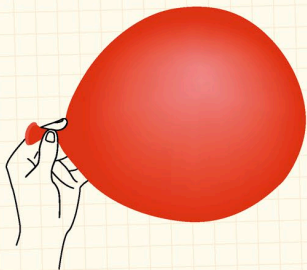


LIFT OFF

Rockets carry satellites, space probes, and astronauts into space. Use a balloon to see how a rocket blasts off from Earth.

1. Blow up the balloon but don't tie the end—hold it between your fingers instead.

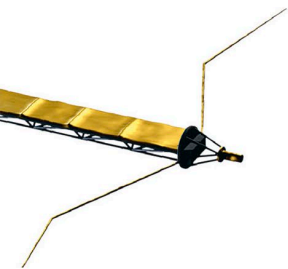


2. Let the balloon go. The air rushing out of the balloon makes it move forward. When a rocket is launched, a stream of hot gases spurts out of its "tail" down toward Earth. The rocket is pushed upward and blasts off into space—just like the balloon.



Catch that drink

Everything is almost weightless in space. Things have to be tied down in case they float away. Drinks are sucked through straws. If any escapes, the drink forms into small balls, which float like little balloons.



A pack on the back

When astronauts are outside their spacecraft they must be careful not to fly off into space. Sometimes they wear backpacks that contain small rockets, allowing the astronauts to control their movements.

